

tion is trying to modify the array, and as such has side effects it should end with a '!'.

That said, this code does show some of the elegance of Ruby, such as the use of constructs like `num1.upto(num2)` for iteration. Ruby has many such idioms that make programming pleasant.

Tools and Learning Resources

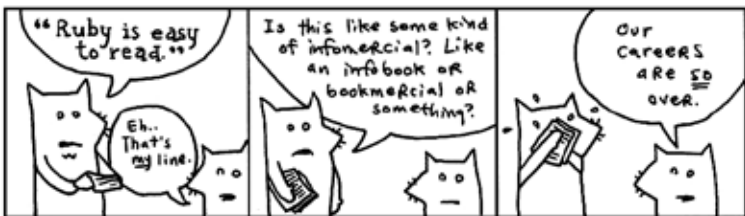
Given the vast community Ruby enjoys, there is no shortage of tutorials dedicated to learning the language. Ruby happens to have a website dedicated to offering detailed interactive tutorials that are not only brilliant, but also free. You can find them at rubymonk.com

Another great website that tests you as you go along is rubykoans.com. However this one is best experienced after you have at least the basic fundamentals of some programming language down. We feel it works better when introducing you to Ruby as a second language rather than the first.

One of the most unconventional (and as such most interesting) tutorials to the language you will find is called “Why’s (Poignant) Guide to Ruby”. If you don’t want to read it for Ruby, read it for the cute illustrations of anthropomorphised foxes. Also it’s the only programming language tutorial / guide we can think of that comes with its own soundtrack. You can find this book at: mislav.uniqpath.com/poignant-guide/

So now that know where to go if you want to get started with Ruby, you probably want to get it installed on your computer. If you are using a Linux or Unix distro, you’ll be happy to know that your distro’s repositories will most definitely have it available.

For Windows and OSX users, the best place to start is ruby-lang.org the official website of the Ruby programming language. For Windows users the best version to get is probably the one available at railsinstaller.org since



A great deal of effort and love seems to have been put into “Why’s (Poignant) Guide to Ruby” to try and make something as dull as learning a new programming language entertaining. The fact that it’s free and under Creative Commons is ever more heartening.